

Khondoker Ittehadul Islam

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Education

University of Groningen, Saarland University

Groningen & Saarbrücken

DOUBLE DEGREE MASTER'S IN NLP

2024 - 2026 (Sept. expected)

- CGPA in German: 1.5/4.0
- Thesis: Analyzing Adaptation Methods on a Unified Framework. (Proposal: 📄)

Shahjalal University of Science and Technology

Sylhet, Bangladesh

B.Sc. (ENGG.) IN COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

2017 - 2021

- CGPA: 3.35/4.00
- Thesis: Language Models in Low-resource Language Tasks.

Skills

Programming & Tools Python, Git, Docker, Slurm, Bash, Weights & Biases, LaTeX

LLM & ML Frameworks PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, vLLM, NumPy, Pandas

Research Areas LLM alignment, Interpretability, Bilingualism, Multi-modality

Publications

- **Khondoker Ittehadul Islam**, Gabriele Sarti; Reveal-Bangla: A Dataset for Cross-Lingual Multi-Step Reasoning Evaluation. **BLP workshop @ IJCNLP-AAACL 2025**. 📄
- **Khondoker Ittehadul Islam**, Tanvir Hossain Yuvraz, Md Saiful Islam, Enamul Hassan; EmoNoBa: A Dataset for Analyzing Fine-Grained Emotions on Noisy Bangla Texts. **AAACL-IJCNLP 2022**. 📄
- **Khondoker Ittehadul Islam**, Sudipta Kar, Md Saiful Islam, Mohammad Ruhul Amin; SentNoB: A Dataset for Analysing Sentiment on Noisy Bangla Texts. **Findings of EMNLP 2021**. 📄
- **Khondoker Ittehadul Islam**, Md Saiful Islam, and Md Ruhul Amin; Sentiment analysis in Bengali via transfer learning using multi-lingual BERT. **ICCIT 2020**. 📄

Professional Experience

2026 - now **Student Research Assistant**, MLT-Lab, DFKI

- Built a holistic safety-evaluation pipeline for foundation models across multiple modalities.
- Designed reproducible LLM-as-a-Judge, robustness, and prompt-injection benchmarks.
- *High-Level Findings Report* 📄

2024 - 2025 **Student Research Intern**, InCLow Lab, University of Groningen

- Analyzed LLM reasoning across languages, variants, and parameter scales.
- Utilized NLI, RAG, and attribution techniques in a cross-lingual evaluation.
- Publications: *BLP workshop @ IJCNLP-AAACL 2025* 📄.

2021 - 2024 **Software Engineer**, REVE Systems

- Digitalized the administrative workflow process of a Transport Organization.
- Incorporated Theory-of-Computation (ToC) concepts to automate the chain-of-decisions.
- Production: <https://smart.dgt.gov.bd/login> 📄

Selected Research Projects

Evaluating VLMs on Multimodal Persuasion Tasks

2026

Saarland University

Saarbrücken, Germany

- Compared the Qwen-VL model family on a persuasive task.
- Found newer Qwen models excel at Logos/Pathos, not Ethos.
- Report: <https://arxiv.org/pdf/2608.01238> 📄

Fallacy Classification in Political Debates via CoT Prompting

2025

University of Groningen

Groningen, Netherlands

- Built CoT prompts (Pragma-Dialectics, Periodic Table) for Qwen-3.
- Found added context often diluted, not aided, accuracy.
- Report: <https://arxiv.org/pdf/2509.11127> 📄

Attributing LLM CoT Reasoning Answers

2025

University of Groningen

Groningen, Netherlands

- Applied ContextCite & Inseq to analyze CoT in Qwen2.5.
- Found attribution overweights final reasoning step.
- Negation/distractors cut coherence & accuracy.
- Received *Best NLP Student Project Award*.
- Report: <https://arxiv.org/pdf/2511.15886> 

Offensive Text Classification Leveraging Sentiment

2024

University of Groningen

Groningen, Netherlands

- Collected sentiment for each OLID instances using DeBERTa V3.
- Observed no positive-sentiment effect on offensive classification.
- Report: <https://arxiv.org/pdf/2412.17825> 

NN Models on Subjective Noisy Language Task

2020-2022

Shahjalal University of Science & Technology

Sylhet, Bangladesh

- Proposed annotation metric for diverse, multi-label corpus.
- Showed Transformers underperform vs. rule-based on noisy text.
- Publications: *Findings of EMNLP 2021* , *AACL-IJCNLP 2022* , *ICCIT 2020* 

Awards

- 2025 **Best NLP Student Project Award**, @GroNLP, University of Groningen
Competed with 6 other student teams to produce impactful research.
- 2025 **Google & Zendesk Scholarship**, LxMLS 2025
Received expenses to participate in Lisbon ML Summer School.
- 2025 **Erasmus+ Scholarship**, Erasmus Mundus
Received stipendium to assist my research traineeship.
- 2024 **NL Scholarship**, Nuffic, Dutch Ministry of Education, Culture, and Science
Awarded stipendium to support my academic endeavors.
- 2023 **Outstanding Reviewer**, BLP Workshop @ EMNLP 2023
Assisted program chairs and authors through constructive feedback.

Academia Services

- 2024-2025 **Programme Committee Member**, ReMa Linguistics, CLCG, University of Groningen
Represented student cohort and provided course structural insights to the Dutch Education Ministry.